

Sushant Kumar

SOCIAL IMPACT COMMUNICATIONS | STORYTELLING |
PODCAST | FUNDRAISING COMMUNICATIONS

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Social impact communications professional with 5+ years of experience shaping narratives, brands, and public engagement for education and development organisations. Selected for the Equity, Representation & Accessibility (ERA) Cohort at the Cannes Lions International Festival of Creativity 2026, France, and an ABBY Award-winning writer for the film *Mothers of Courage*. Passionate about translating complex social change into narratives that influence policy, partnerships, and public discourse.

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EDUCATION

Sainik School Nalanda, Bihar | High School
Physics, Chemistry & Maths | 72.05%
June 2009 - March 2016

Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak | Graduation
Bachelor of Education | 73%
August 2023 - July 2025

Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi | Graduation
B.A. (Hons.) Political Science | 80.45%
June 2017 - September 2020

Azim Premji University, Bangalore | Post-Graduation
M.A. Education | 8.3/10 CGPA
September 2020 - June 2022

WORK EXPERIENCE

Manager, Communications - Mantra4Change Apr 2025 - Present

- Led and mentored the communications team, strengthening storytelling, brand consistency, and program visibility across Bihar, Karnataka, and Uttar Pradesh.
- Directed a statewide Brand Perception Survey, contributing to a 20% improvement in the Brand Health Index of Mantra4Change.
- Executive Producer of InvokED Studio, a video podcast featuring leaders from education and the social impact sector.
- Developed donor communication assets and fundraising collateral for international partnerships and philanthropic engagements.
- Took *Mothers of Courage*, India's only SDG Lions shortlisted campaign, to Cannes Lions 2026; selected for the ERA Cohort.

Associate Manager, Communications - Mantra4Change Oct 2023 - Mar 2025

- Created fundraising stories and assets for Dialogue for Social Equity, USA, driving greater donor engagement and contributions.
- Co-authored thought leadership articles with the Co-founders & COO for tier-1 media platforms, strengthening organizational positioning.
- Facilitated internal Learning & Development (L&D) sessions, embedding a culture of storytelling in the organization.
- Designed and executed a hiring pipeline, expanding the team with high-caliber talent and diverse skill sets.

Program Communications Lead - Mantra4Change **June 2022 - Sep 2023 (Full-time)**

- Built and implemented a comprehensive communications strategy covering messaging, positioning, channels, and audiences.
- Produced blogs, case studies, articles, and program films that demonstrated on-ground impact and innovation.
- Scripted and coordinated multiple program film productions by working with external vendors to ensure high-quality outputs.
- Handled branding and campaigns for Mantra4Change's 10th Anniversary, including pre- and post-event social media communications.

Academic Mentor, Roshni Program - CREA **Nov 2024 - Oct 2025 (Part-time)**

- Mentored 12 cohort members over a 10-month *Roshni fellowship* focused on integrating constitutional values into grassroots social action.
- Facilitated online learning sessions on the constitutional principles of democracy, liberty, equality, justice, fraternity, and dignity.
- Guided fellows in designing contextually relevant learning materials for their respective communities.
- Conducted in-person review meetings to provide feedback and strengthen the fellows' Social Action Projects (SAPs).
- Supported the cohort in translating constitutional ideals into actionable community practices.

Design & Communications Consultant - Language and Learning Foundation **Feb 2025 - Present (Part-time)**

- Contributed to the 10-Year Impact Report, ensuring narrative clarity and visual coherence.
- Co-developed a teacher handbook to support FLN classroom implementation.
- Supported the team on branding and collateral design for streamlined and consistent communication.

Co-Founder - Dialogues on Democracy & Development **June 2021 - Present (Part-time)**

- Co-founded an initiative to promote constitutional literacy and civic participation across India.
- Established partnerships with government bodies, NGOs, and academic institutions – 15 partner organizations to date.
- Produced the video lecture series "*Siddhant Samvidhan Ke*" on constitutional values.
- Delivered 40 workshops across 12 cities, engaging 4000+ participants in conversations on democracy and civic responsibility.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Selected for the ERA Cohort 2026 at Cannes Lions International Festival of Creativity, France
- Selected by Azim Premji University for the Alumni Incubator Accelerator Program
- Research paper "Can Constitutional Morality lead to improved civic engagement?" selected for the National Conference at Kerala University
- Invited panellist – Constitutional Values & Community Engagement, CREA
- RASTA Fellow (2024-25) for promoting constitutional literacy

SKILLS

Creative Writing & Editing
Podcast & Video Production
Strategic Communications
Leadership & Mentoring

Donor Communication
Social Media Campaigns
Logical & Analytical Thinking
Curriculum Development
